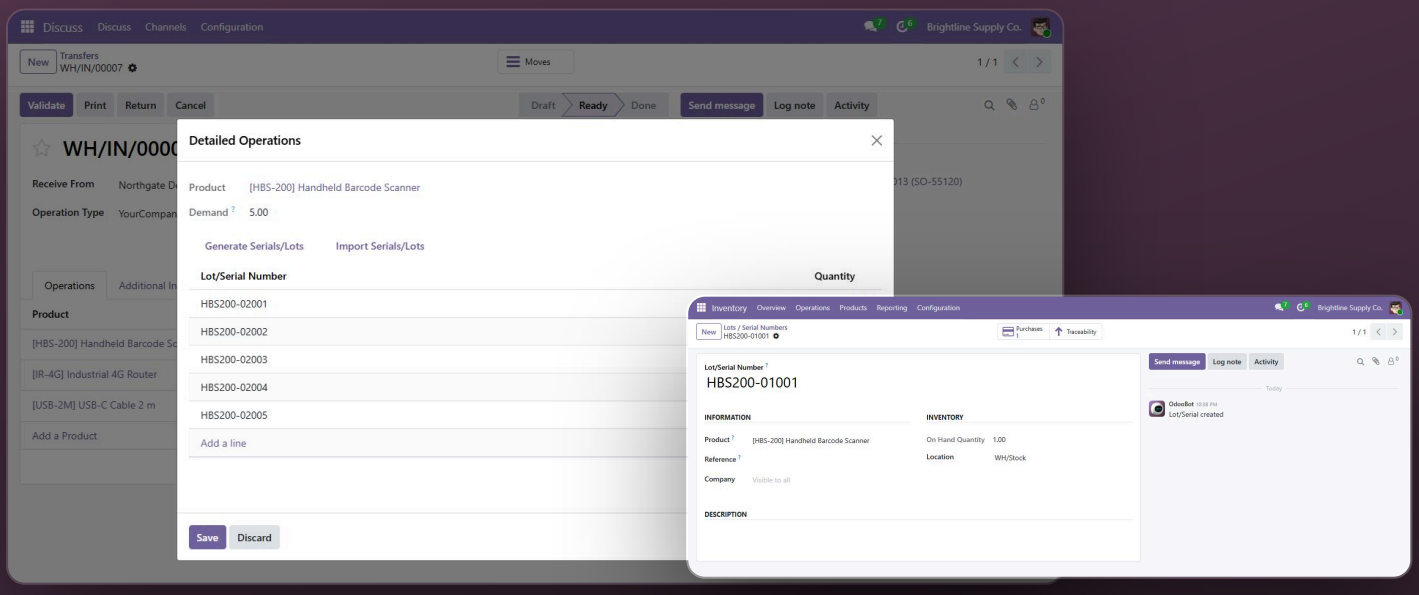
WAY4TECH SOLUTIONS

Works on
Odoo 19 Community and Enterprise
Purchase + Inventory

STEP BY STEP GUIDE · STANDARD ODOO, NO EXTRA MODULE

Serial Numbers on Purchase Receipts in Odoo 19

Record the serial or lot number of every unit you buy, on the receipt that comes from the purchase order, so each unit can be traced back to its vendor. Settings, products, receipts, errors and traceability, one screen at a time.



START

About this guide

When you buy goods that carry a serial number, such as scanners, routers or tablets, you want to know which vendor supplied which unit, and when. Odoo does this with its standard Purchase and Inventory apps; no extra module is needed. This guide walks the whole flow on a worked example.

Who it is for

The purchasing and receiving team, the warehouse manager who sets Odoo up, and anyone who has to answer 'where did this unit come from'.

What you need

Odoo 19 Community or Enterprise with Purchase and Inventory installed, and a user with Inventory administrator rights to change the settings.

The worked example

Brightline Supply Co., an invented wholesaler, buys handheld scanners and routers (one serial per unit) and thermal paste (lots with an expiry date) from two invented vendors. Every screenshot is from a clean Odoo 19 database set up this way.

Serial or lot: which one you need

	SERIAL NUMBER	LOT
Identifies	Exactly one unit	A batch of units made or delivered together
Quantity per number	Always 1	Any quantity
Typical goods	Electronics, tools, machines, anything with a warranty	Food, chemicals, medicines, paint, anything with a batch or expiry
On a receipt of 5	Five numbers	One number, or a few if the batch is split
Can the same number come twice	No, Odoo refuses it for the same product	Yes, more stock can join a lot

The flow in this guide

1. **Settings** — Lots & Serial Numbers on
2. **Product** — Track by serial or lot
3. **Purchase order** — Confirm, a receipt is made
4. **Receipt** — Enter one serial per unit
5. **Validate** — Stock in, traceable

What is in the guide

PART 1	Turn on lots and serial numbers	PART 2	Choose which products are tracked
PART 3	Check the Receipts operation type	PART 4	Buy the goods: the purchase order
PART 5	Receive the goods with their serial numbers	PART 6	Lots with expiry dates, and partial receipts
PART 7	When the receipt will not validate	PART 8	Find, trace and label the units
PART 9	Stock you already hold, and returns	PART 10	Questions, a checklist and the menu map

PART 1 Turn on lots and serial numbers

Tracking is off in a new database. Turn it on once, in the Inventory settings.

IN THIS PART YOU WILL LEARN

- Where the Traceability settings are
- What each of the four settings does

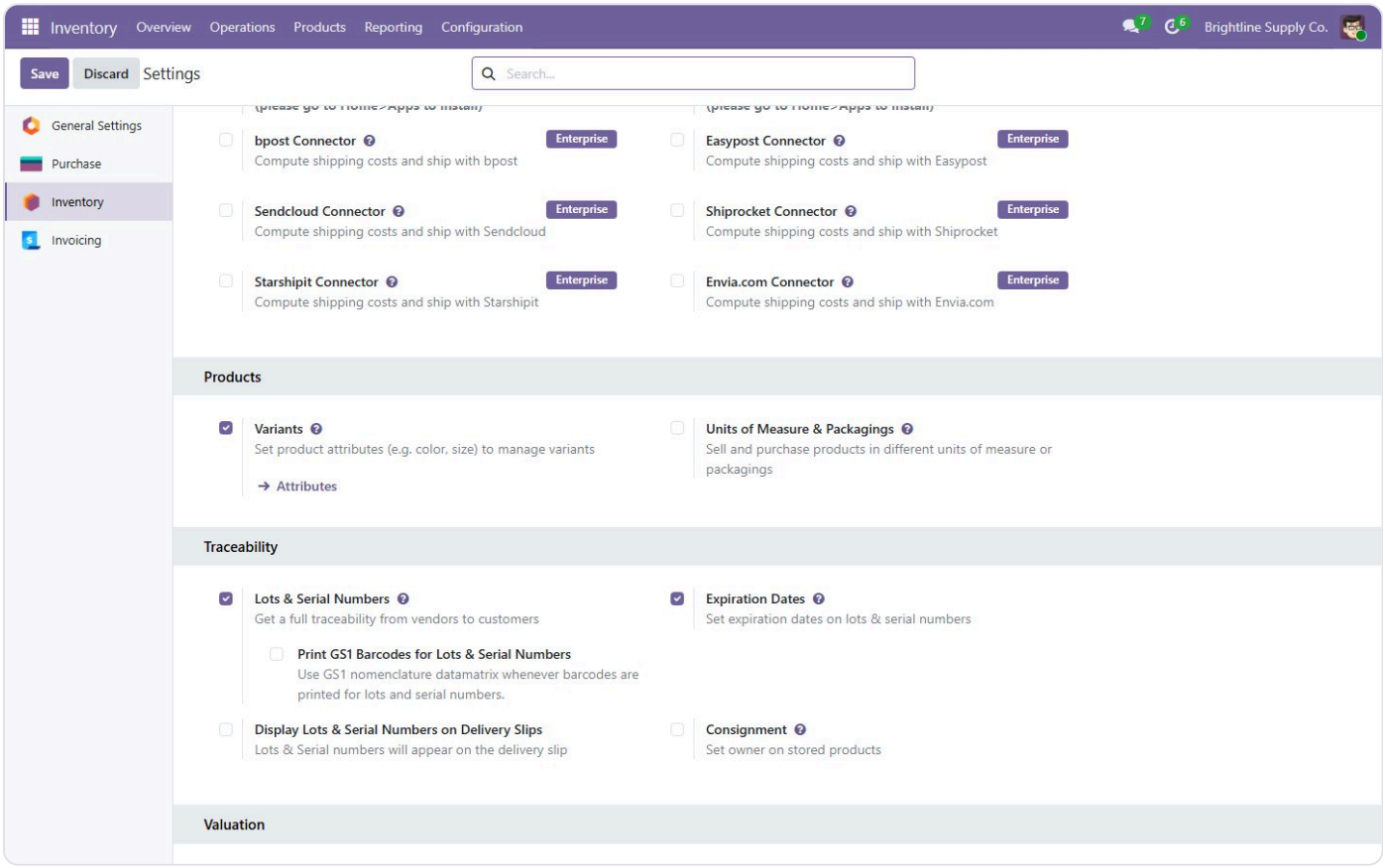
DO IT ON YOUR DATABASE

1. Open Inventory, Configuration, Settings
2. Scroll to Traceability
3. Tick Lots & Serial Numbers and press Save

1 Open the Traceability section

Go to **Inventory, Configuration, Settings** and scroll to **Traceability**. Tick **Lots & Serial Numbers** and press **Save** at the top.

> Saving needs the Inventory administrator right. The page reloads; the new menus and fields appear straight away.



SETTING	WHAT IT DOES	TURN IT ON WHEN
Lots & Serial Numbers	Adds the tracking choice on products, the Lots / Serial Numbers menu, the Details on receipt lines and the traceability report	Always, for this guide
Print GS1 Barcodes for Lots & Serial Numbers	Lot and serial labels use a GS1 Data Matrix that carries the product and the number	Your customers or scanners expect GS1 codes
Expiration Dates	Adds expiry, best before, removal and alert dates to lots and serials (installs Product Expiry)	You buy goods that expire
Display Lots & Serial Numbers on Delivery Slips	Prints the numbers on the delivery slip you send to customers	Customers need the serials on their paperwork

PART 2 Choose which products are tracked

Tracking is set per product. A product that is not tracked is received as before, with no number to type.

IN THIS PART YOU WILL LEARN

- Setting a product to serial or lot tracking
- Expiry dates per product
- What happens when a product with stock is switched

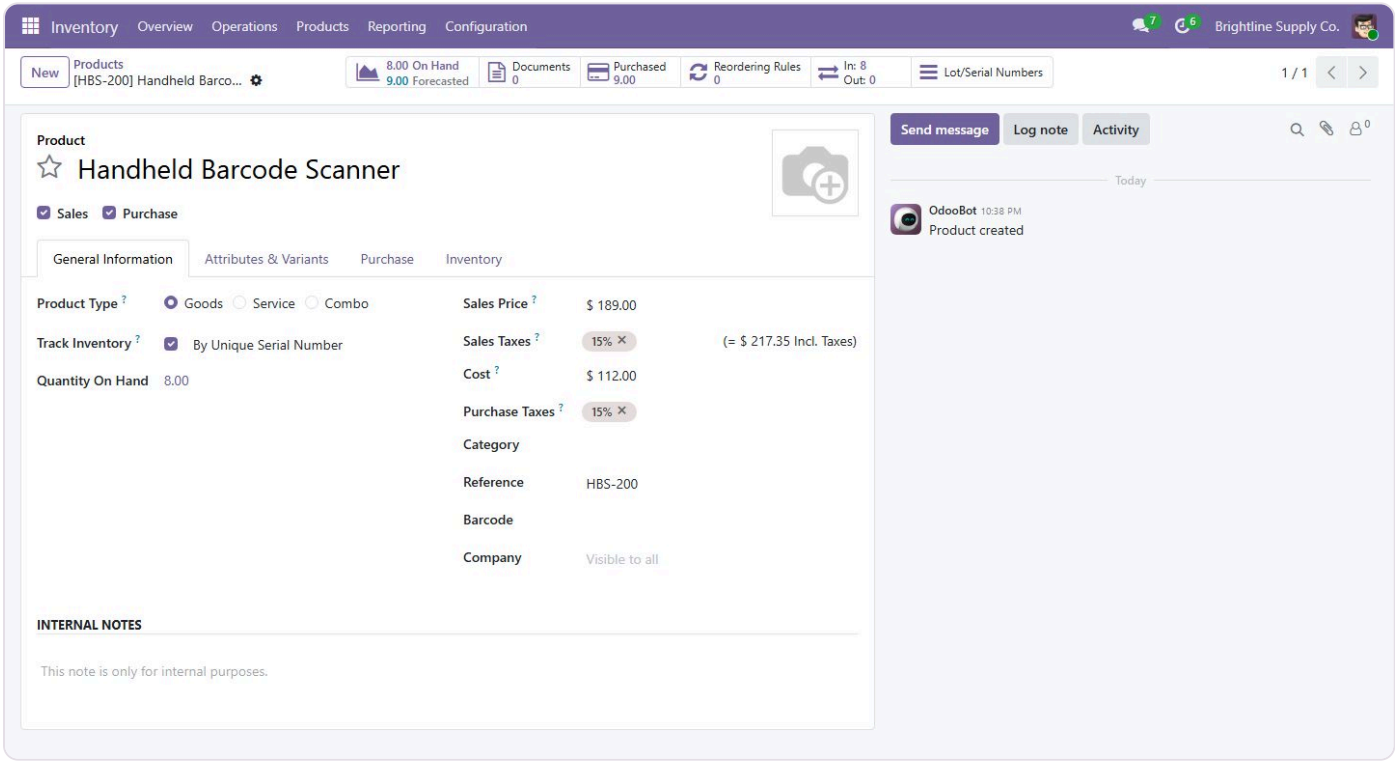
DO IT ON YOUR DATABASE

1. Open Inventory, Products, Products and pick a storable product
2. Next to Track Inventory choose By Unique Serial Number
3. Save

1 Set a product to serial tracking

Open the product. On the **General Information** tab, **Product Type** must be Goods and **Track Inventory** ticked. Next to it choose **By Unique Serial Number**, or **By Lots** for goods bought in batches such as the thermal paste here. Save.

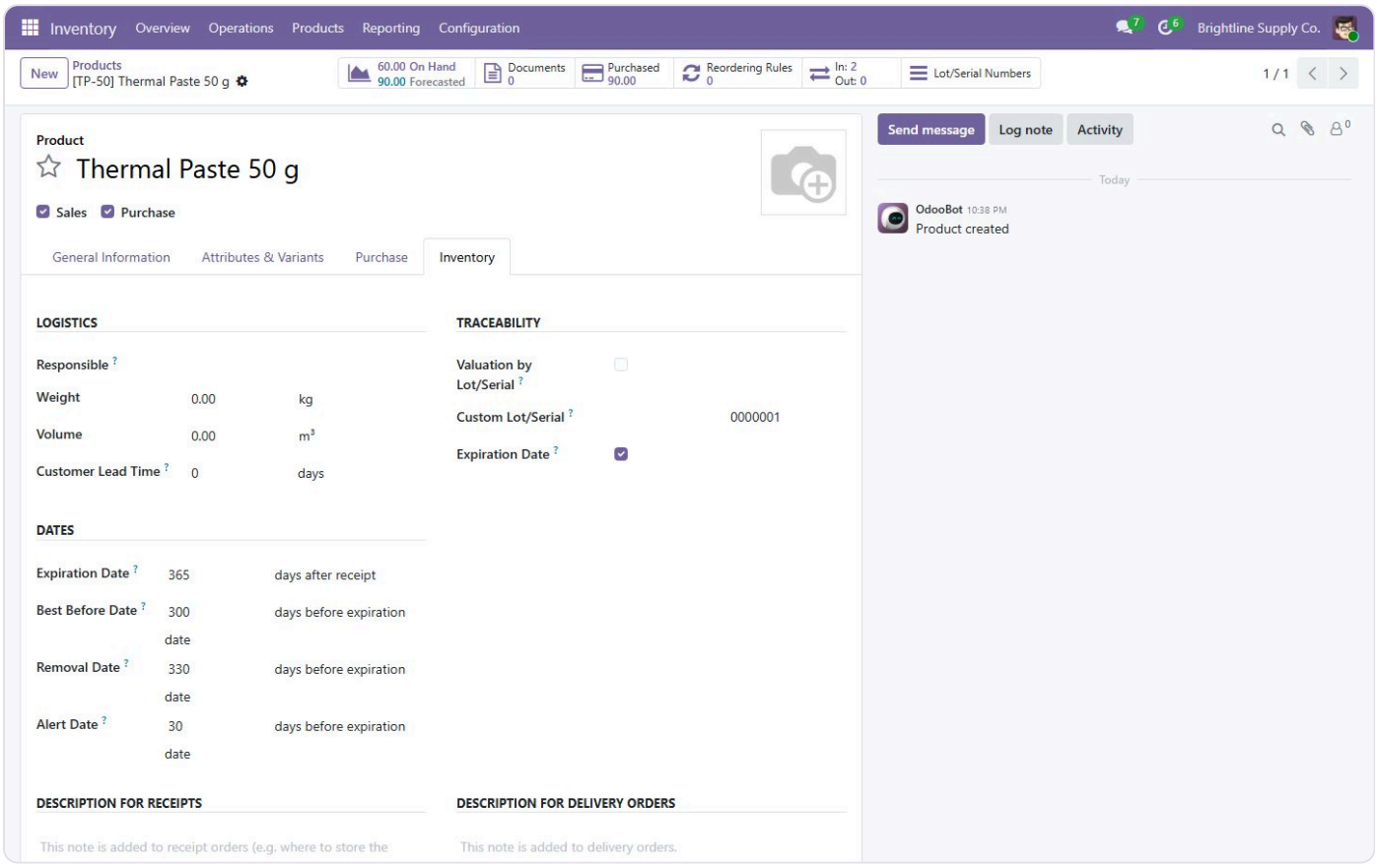
> The choices are By Quantity (no number), By Lots and By Unique Serial Number. The Lot/Serial Numbers smart button at the top opens the numbers of this product.



2 Expiry dates for a lot tracked product

With Expiration Dates on, the **Inventory** tab has **Expiration Date** ticked and a **Dates** block: Expiration Date (days after receipt), Best Before Date, Removal Date and Alert Date (days before expiration). Odoo uses them to fill the dates of each new lot when it is received.

> Here a lot expires 365 days after receipt, is best before 300 days earlier, is removed 330 days earlier and raises an alert 30 days before.



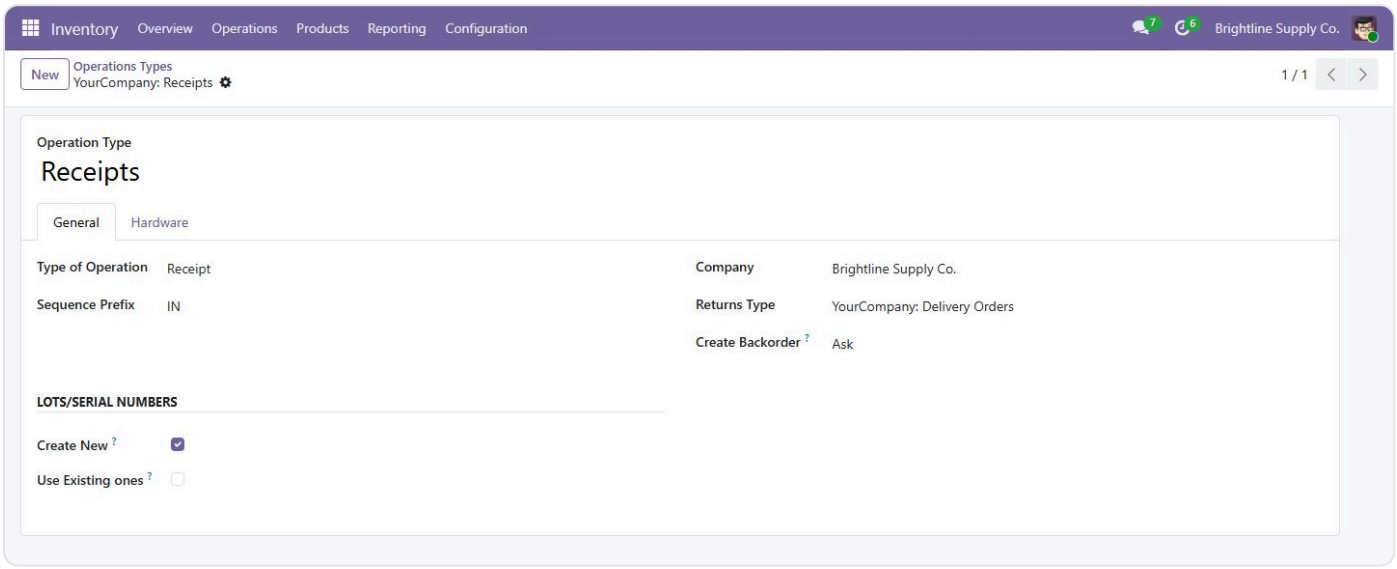
> Switching a product to tracking while it has stock: Odoo lets you save, but warns that you hold stock with no serial or lot number. Those units stay without numbers until you give them one with a physical inventory (part 8). It is simpler to switch before the next delivery arrives.

PART 3 Check the Receipts operation type

Two boxes on the Receipts operation type decide whether people may type new numbers on a receipt, or must pick numbers that already exist.

1 Open the Receipts operation type

Go to **Inventory, Configuration, Operation Types** and open **Receipts**. The **Lots/Serial Numbers** block has **Create New** and **Use Existing ones**.



CREATE NEW	USE EXISTING ONES	ON THE RECEIPT
On (the default)	Off	You type or generate new numbers; Odoo creates them when the receipt is validated. Right for goods from vendors
Off	On	You pick numbers already in Odoo. Used for returns from customers or internal moves
On	On	Both: type a new number or pick an existing one

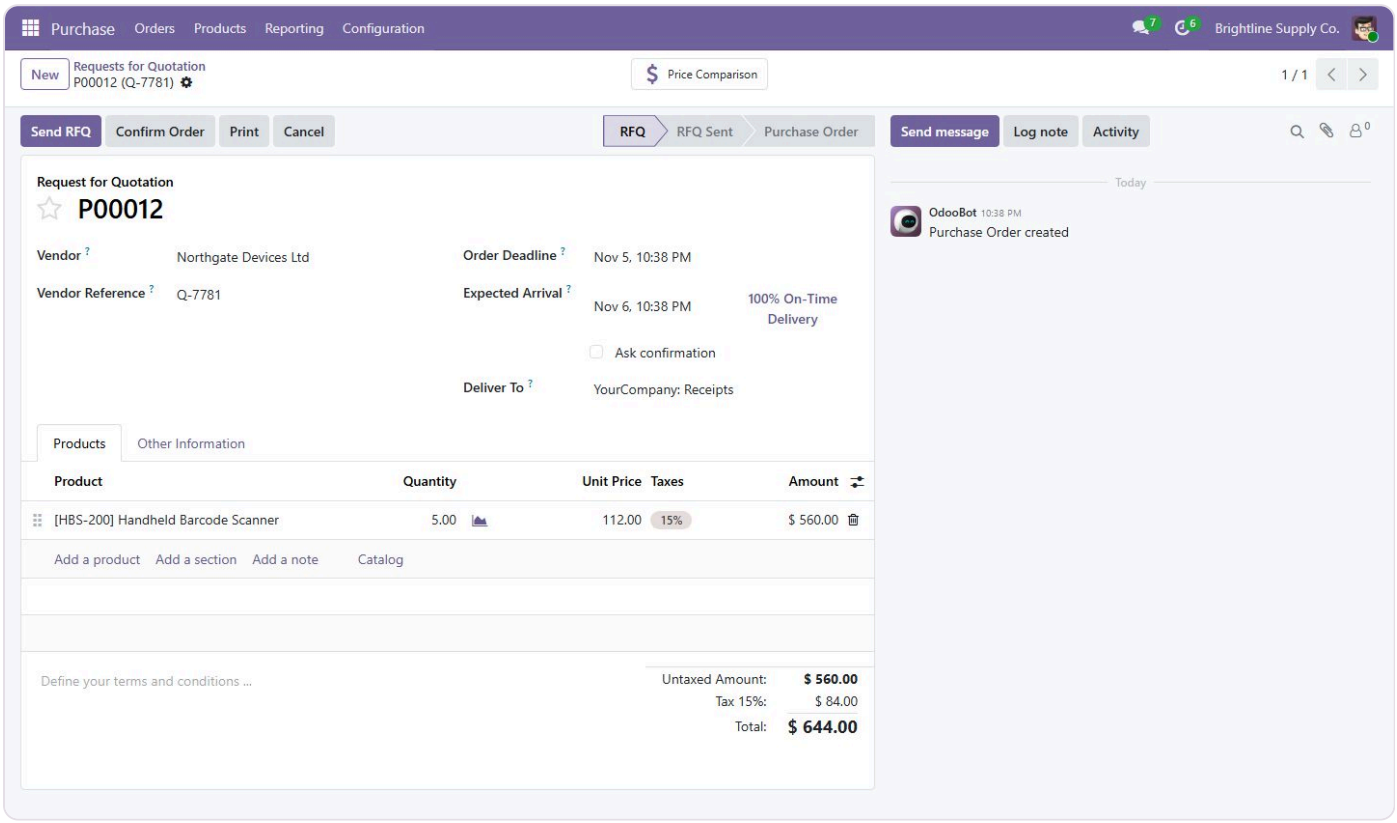
Each warehouse has its own Receipts type. Check them all if you run several warehouses.

PART 4 Buy the goods: the purchase order

Nothing changes on the purchase order itself. Odoo has no serial number field on a purchase order line; the numbers are entered on the receipt the confirmed order creates.

1 Create the request for quotation

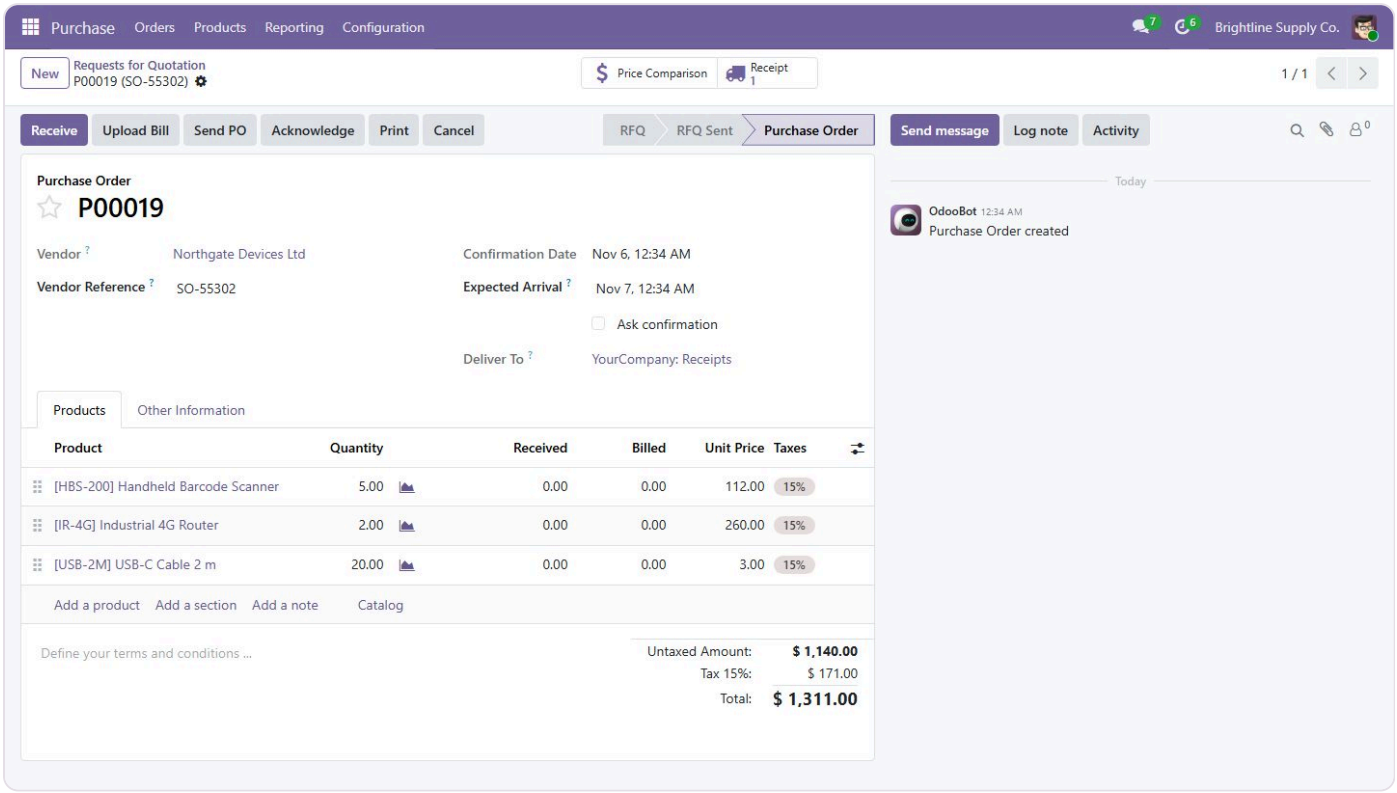
In **Purchase**, press **New**, choose the vendor, add the lines and quantities. Here, five scanners from Northgate Devices Ltd, with the vendor's reference.



2 Confirm it

Press **Confirm Order**. The order becomes a Purchase Order and a **Receipt** smart button appears at the top. The Received column stays at zero until the goods are booked in.

> Press **Receive** (or the Receipt button) to open the receipt.



PART 5 Receive the goods with their serial numbers

This is the heart of the guide. Each tracked line on the receipt has a Details button. Open it, enter one serial per unit by typing, generating or importing them, save, and validate.

IN THIS PART YOU WILL LEARN

- The Details dialog of a receipt line
- Typing serials one by one, or scanning them
- Generate: a run of numbers from a first one
- Import: paste a list from the vendor
- Validating the receipt

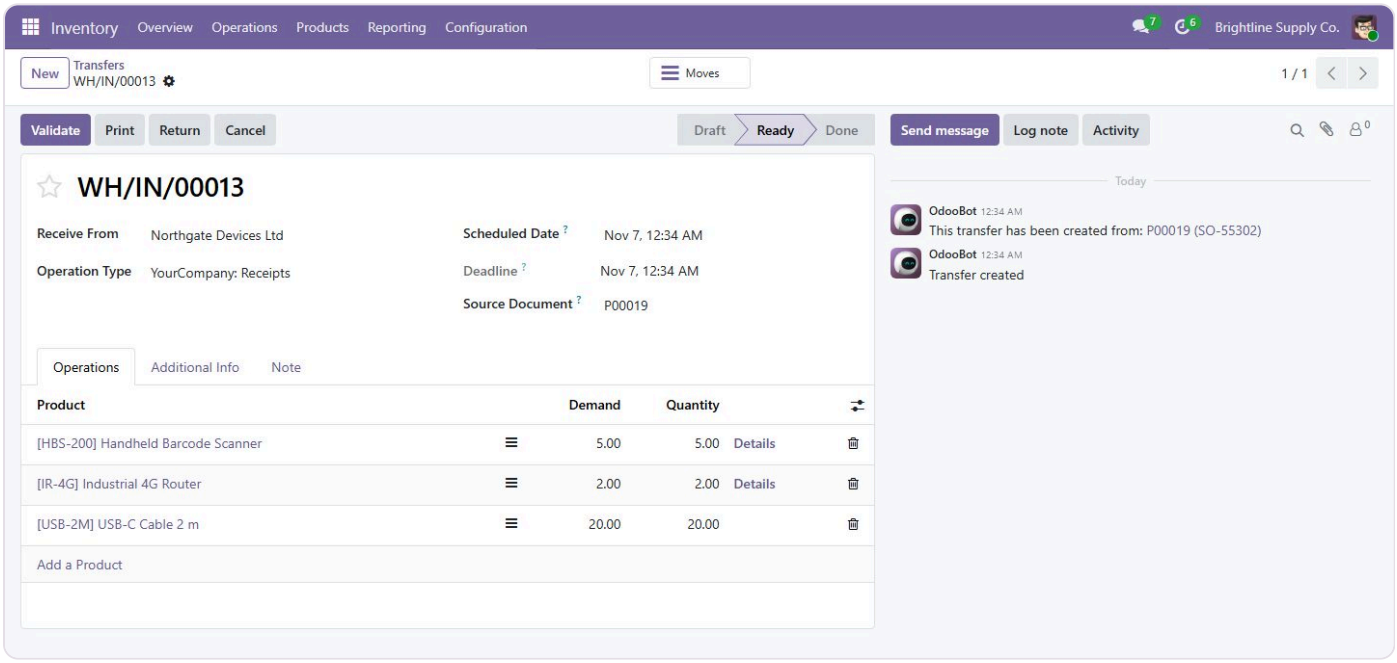
DO IT ON YOUR DATABASE

1. Open a receipt with a serial tracked product
2. Press Details on the line, then Generate Serials/Lots
3. Enter the first serial and the count, Generate, Save, then Validate

1 Open the receipt

The receipt lists each product with its **Demand** and **Quantity**. Tracked lines have a **Details** link; the cable, which is not tracked, has none.

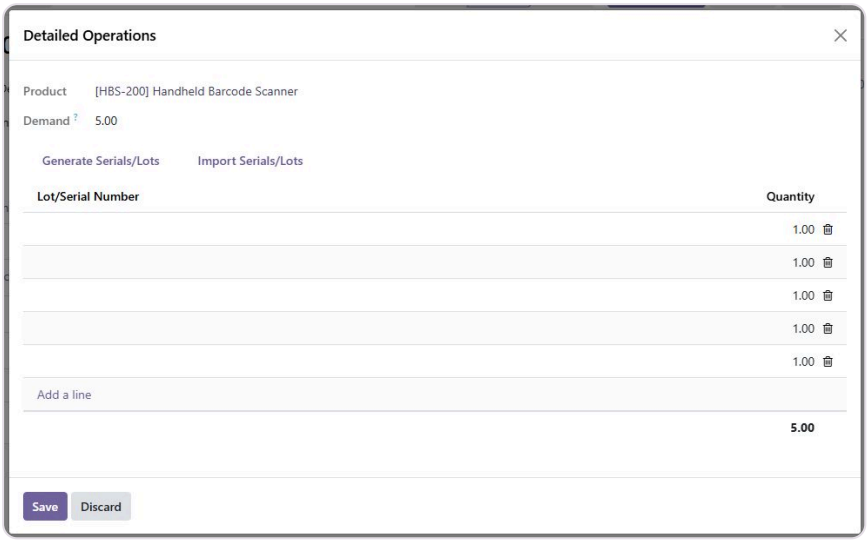
> Odoo fills Quantity with the demand, but a tracked line still needs its numbers before it can be validated.



2 Press Details

The **Detailed Operations** dialog shows the product, the demand and one line per unit with an empty **Lot/Serial Number**. Click a line and type the number from the unit's label, or scan it with a USB barcode scanner, which types it for you and moves to the next line.

> **Add a line** adds one more. The total at the bottom must reach the demand for a full receipt.



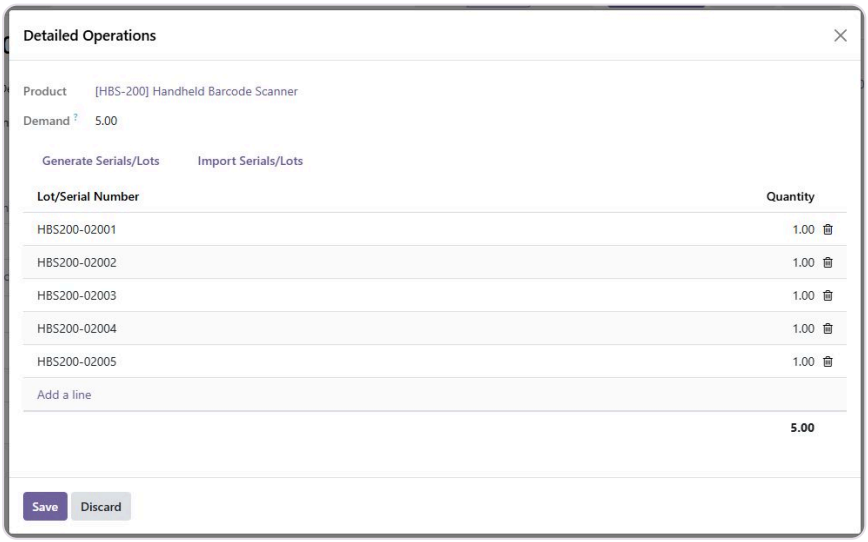
3 Or generate a run of numbers

Press **Generate Serials/Lots**. Enter the **First Serial Number** and the **Number of SN**. Odoo counts on from the digits at the end, so HBS200-02001 and 5 gives HBS200-02001 to HBS200-02005. **Keep current lines** keeps numbers already entered; untick it to replace them.



4 Check the generated numbers

Press **Generate**. The dialog lists the five serials. Check them against the units, change any that differ, then press **Save**.



5 Or import a list

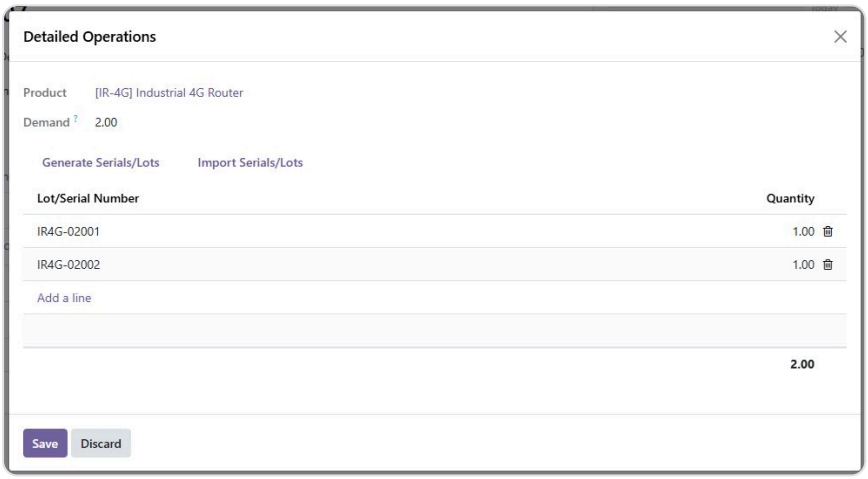
On the router line, press **Details**, then **Import Serials/Lots**. Paste the numbers, one per line, for example from the vendor's packing list or spreadsheet. Keep current lines works as above. Press **Generate**.

> For lots, each line of the import can carry a quantity after the lot name.



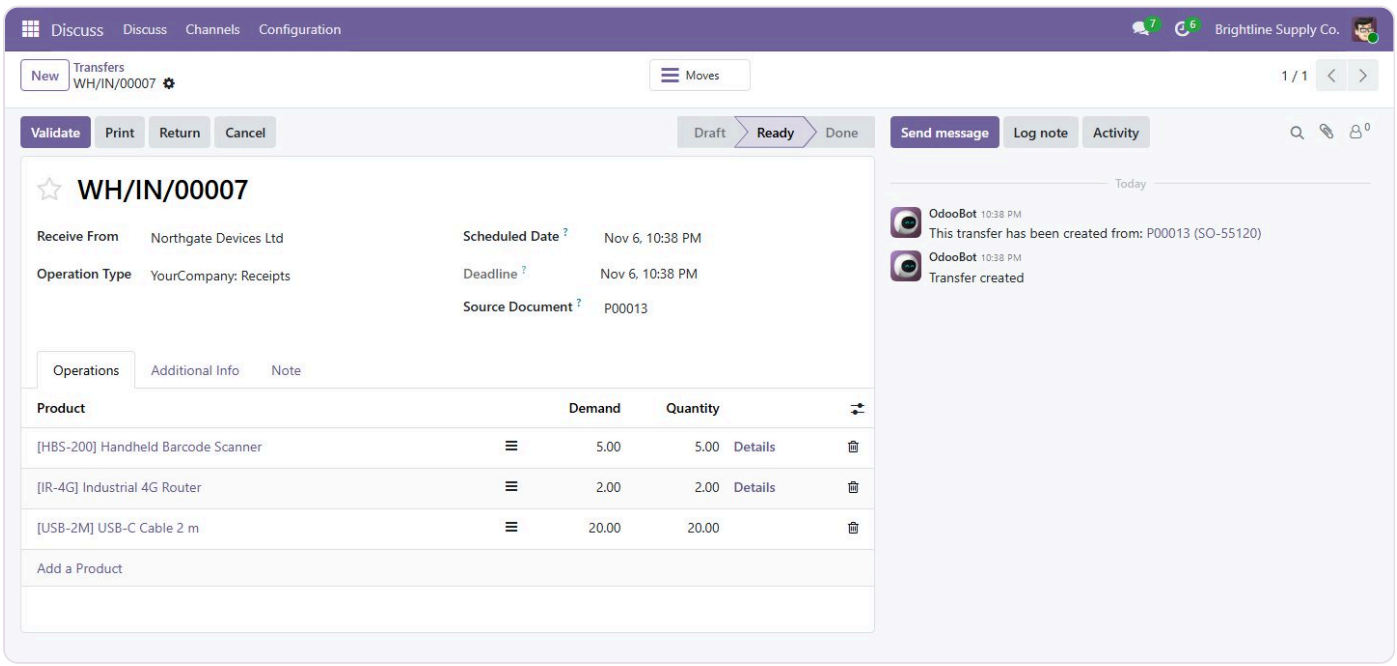
6 Check and save

The imported serials appear, one per unit. Press **Save**.



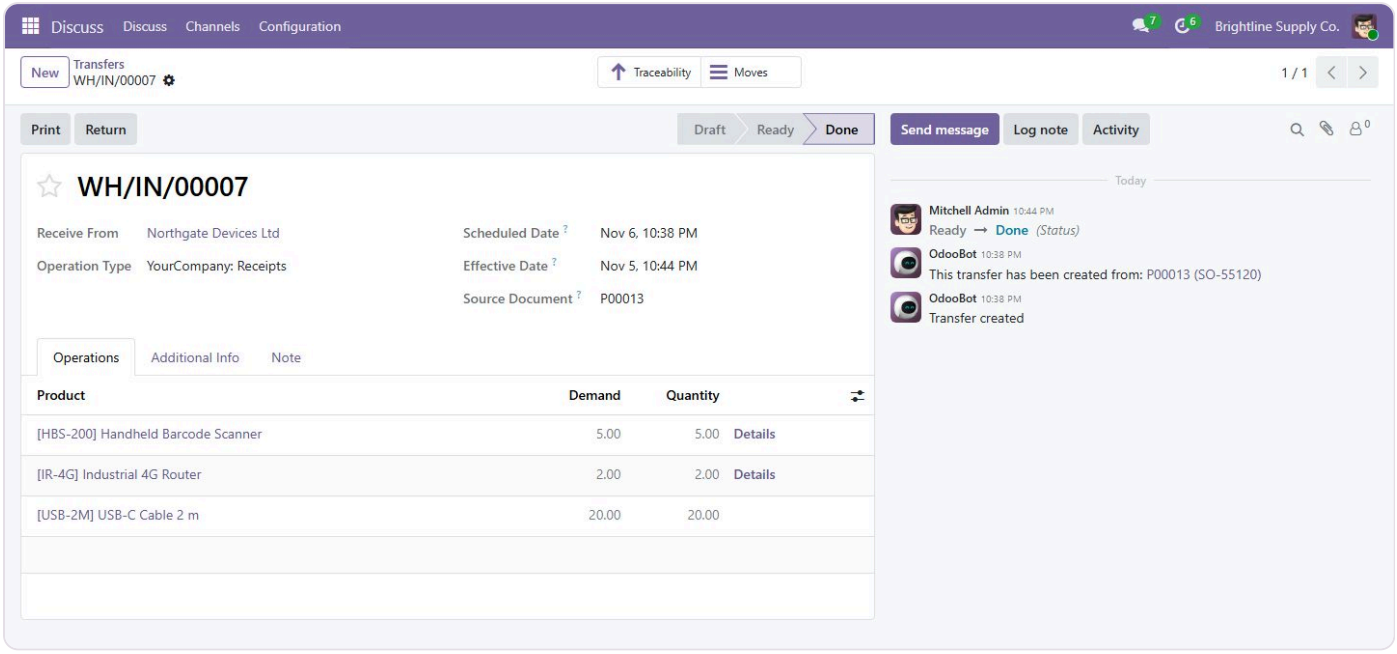
7 Validate the receipt

Back on the receipt, every tracked line now holds its serials. Press **Validate**. The receipt moves to **Done**, the serials are created, the stock goes into WH/Stock and the purchase order's Received column is updated.



8 The finished receipt

A done receipt shows a **Traceability** button at the top and keeps its Details, now read only, so you can always see which serials came in on it.

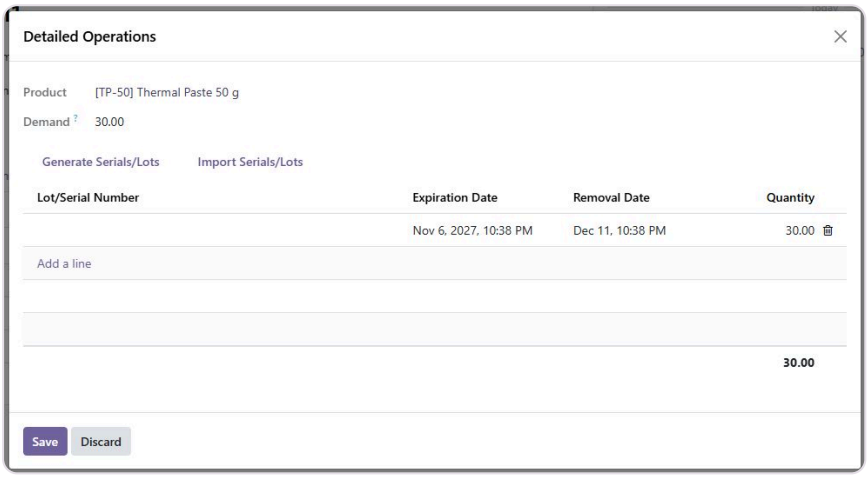


PART 6 Lots with expiry dates, and partial receipts

Lot tracked goods follow the same steps with one difference: a line carries a quantity, and with Expiration Dates on, its dates.

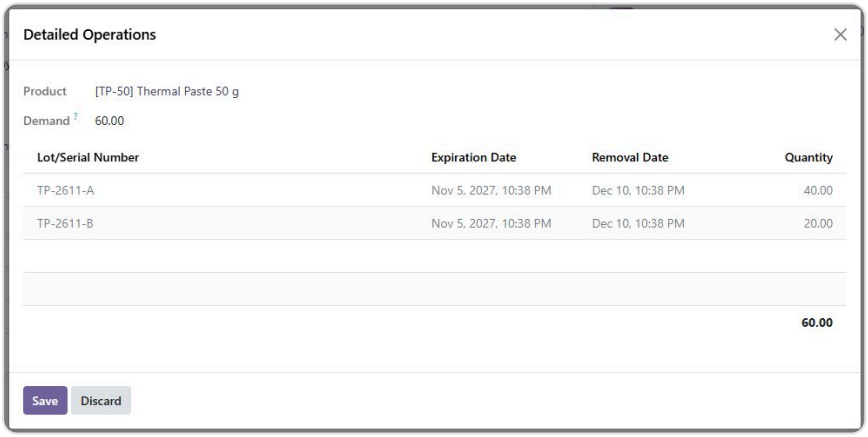
1 A lot line on a receipt

For a lot tracked product the Details dialog has one line per lot. Type the lot name from the vendor's label and the quantity in that lot. The **Expiration Date** and **Removal Date** are filled from the product's settings; change them to what the label says.



2 One delivery, two lots

Sixty tubes came in two batches: 40 in lot TP-2611-A and 20 in TP-2611-B. Two lines, each with its quantity and dates.



3 Only part of the delivery arrived

Here one tablet of four has its serial entered. Enter serials only for the units that came, remove or zero the other lines, save and validate. Odoo asks whether to create a **backorder** for the rest; choose it and the remaining units wait on a new receipt with their own Details.



PART 7 When the receipt will not validate

Odoo stops a receipt rather than let a tracked unit in without its number, or with a number it already has.

1 A unit has no serial

You need to supply a Lot/Serial Number for product, followed by the products concerned. Close the message, open Details on those lines and fill them.



2 The serial is already in Odoo

The serial number has already been assigned, naming the product and the serial. The same serial cannot be received twice for one product. Check the label: a typing slip, a unit received before, or a vendor that reused a number.



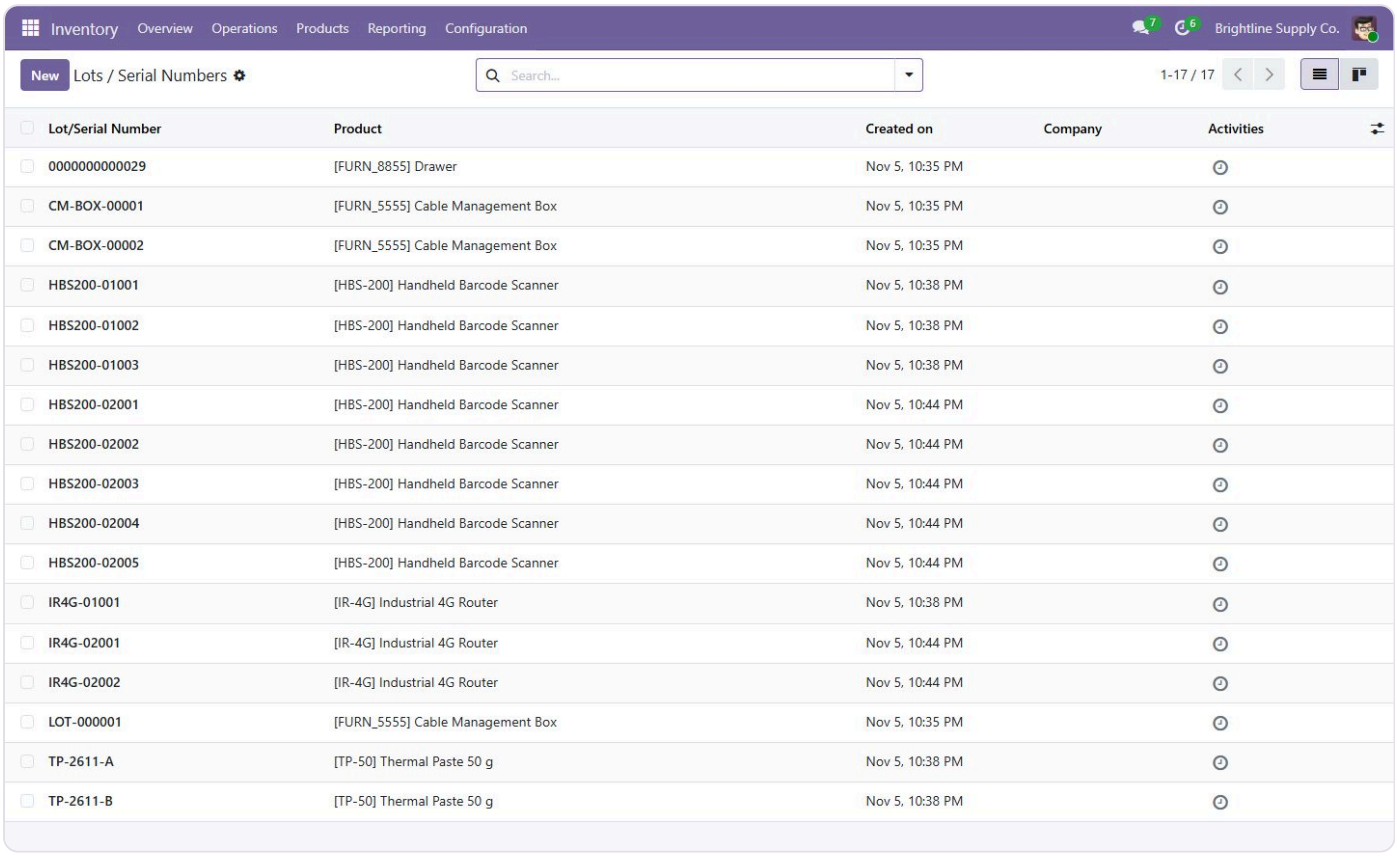
MESSAGE OR SYMPTOM	WHAT TO DO
You need to supply a Lot/Serial Number	Fill the Details of every tracked line named
The serial number has already been assigned	Correct the number; search it under Lots / Serial Numbers to see where the first one is
No Details link on a line	The product is not tracked: set Track Inventory to By Unique Serial Number or By Lots
Cannot type a new number	Create New is off on the Receipts operation type (part 3)
A serial line shows more than 1	A serial always holds one unit; split it into one line per unit

PART 8 Find, trace and label the units

Once validated, every serial and lot is a record of its own, linked to the purchase order and the receipt it came on.

1 The Lots / Serial Numbers list

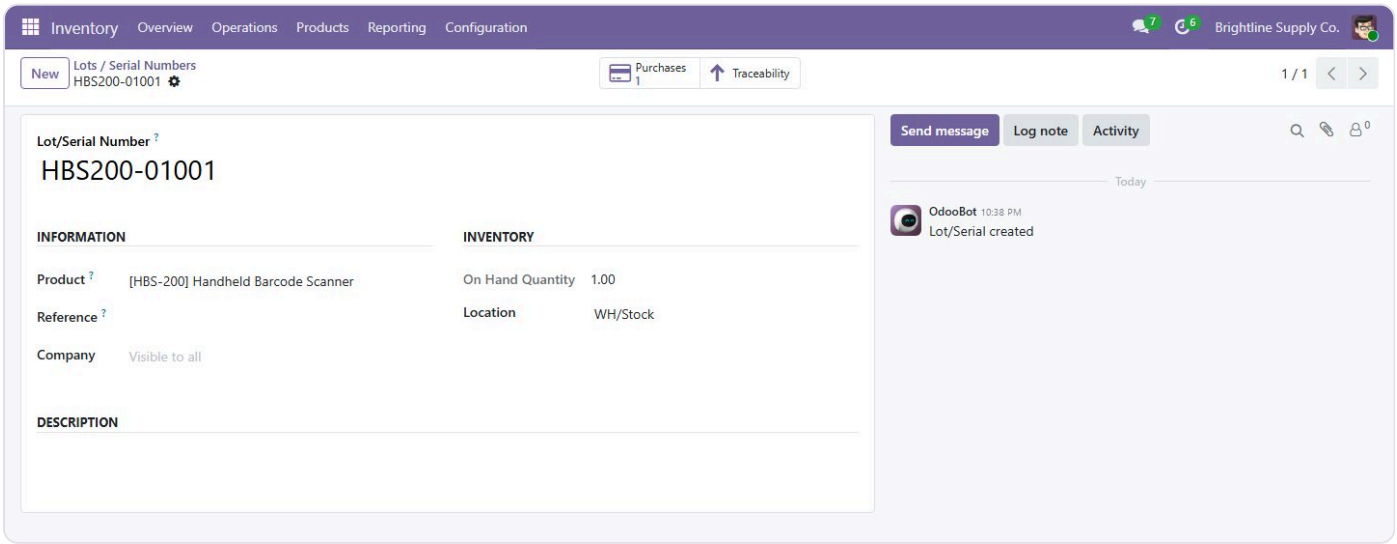
Go to **Inventory, Products, Lots/Serial Numbers**. Search a number, or group by product. Each row shows the product and when the number was created.



Lot/Serial Number	Product	Created on	Company	Activities
0000000000029	[FURN_8855] Drawer	Nov 5, 10:35 PM		
CM-BOX-00001	[FURN_5555] Cable Management Box	Nov 5, 10:35 PM		
CM-BOX-00002	[FURN_5555] Cable Management Box	Nov 5, 10:35 PM		
HBS200-01001	[HBS-200] Handheld Barcode Scanner	Nov 5, 10:38 PM		
HBS200-01002	[HBS-200] Handheld Barcode Scanner	Nov 5, 10:38 PM		
HBS200-01003	[HBS-200] Handheld Barcode Scanner	Nov 5, 10:38 PM		
HBS200-02001	[HBS-200] Handheld Barcode Scanner	Nov 5, 10:44 PM		
HBS200-02002	[HBS-200] Handheld Barcode Scanner	Nov 5, 10:44 PM		
HBS200-02003	[HBS-200] Handheld Barcode Scanner	Nov 5, 10:44 PM		
HBS200-02004	[HBS-200] Handheld Barcode Scanner	Nov 5, 10:44 PM		
HBS200-02005	[HBS-200] Handheld Barcode Scanner	Nov 5, 10:44 PM		
IR4G-01001	[IR-4G] Industrial 4G Router	Nov 5, 10:38 PM		
IR4G-02001	[IR-4G] Industrial 4G Router	Nov 5, 10:44 PM		
IR4G-02002	[IR-4G] Industrial 4G Router	Nov 5, 10:44 PM		
LOT-000001	[FURN_5555] Cable Management Box	Nov 5, 10:35 PM		
TP-2611-A	[TP-50] Thermal Paste 50 g	Nov 5, 10:38 PM		
TP-2611-B	[TP-50] Thermal Paste 50 g	Nov 5, 10:38 PM		

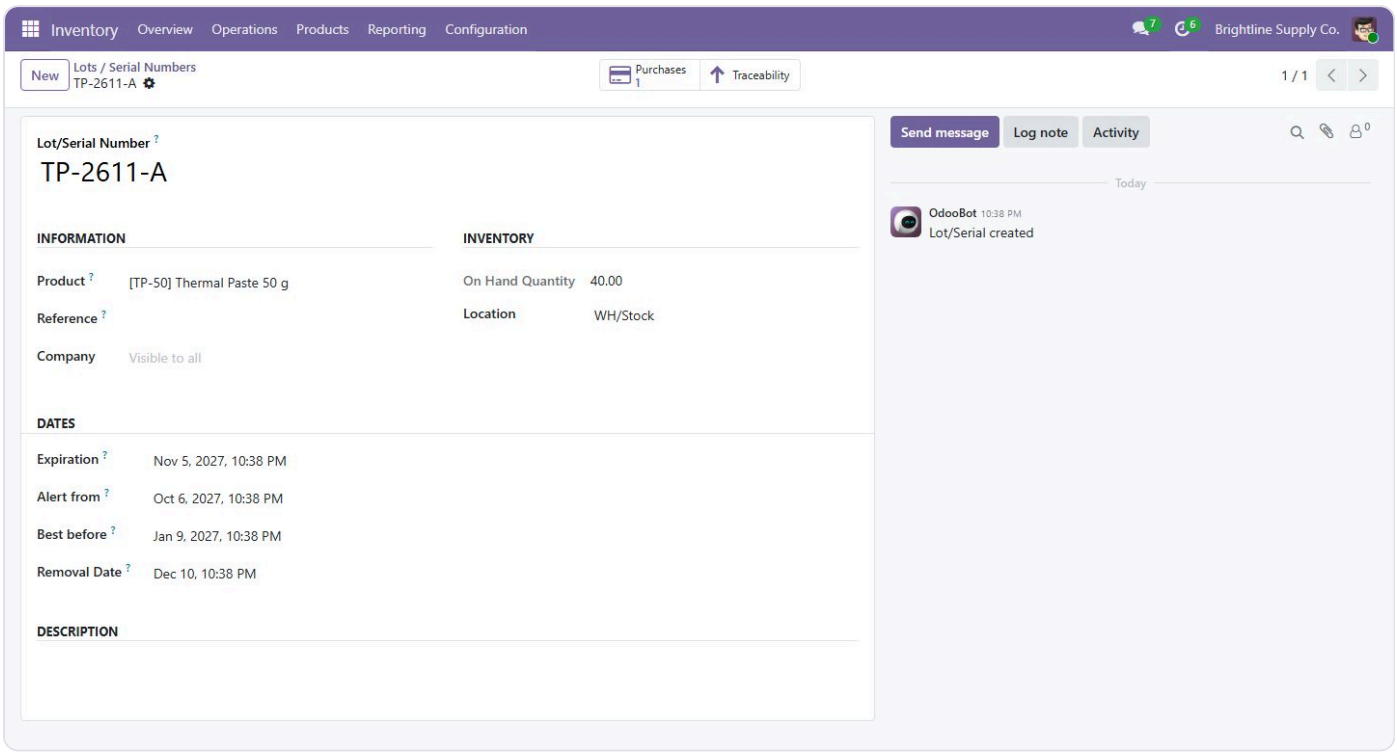
2 A serial number

Open one. It shows the product, an internal reference, the company, the quantity on hand and the location. The **Purchase** smart button opens the order it came on; **Traceability** opens its history.



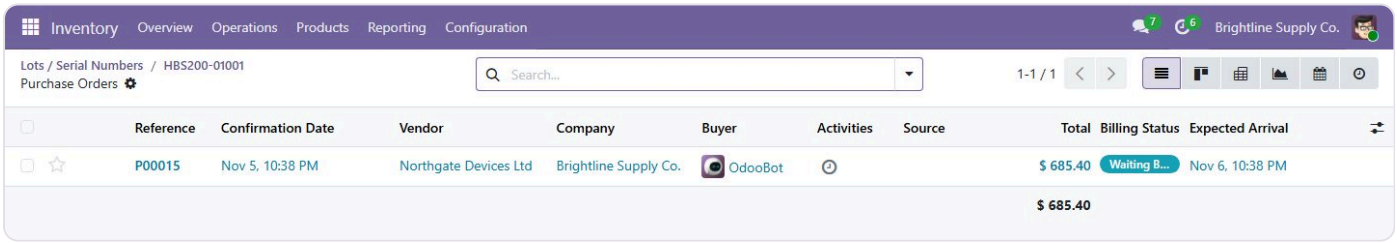
3 A lot with dates

A lot of an expiring product also shows Expiration, Alert, Best before and Removal dates.



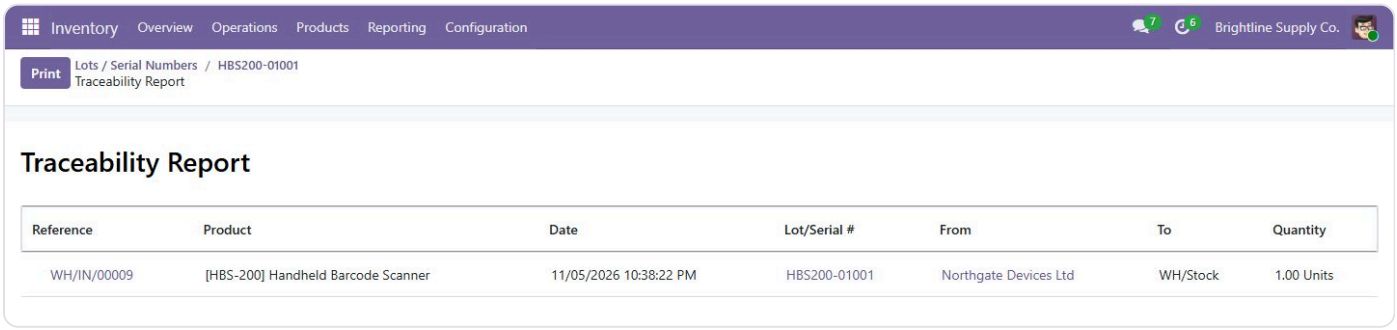
4 Which purchase order

Purchase lists the purchase orders that brought this number in, with the vendor, so 'who sold us this unit' is one click.



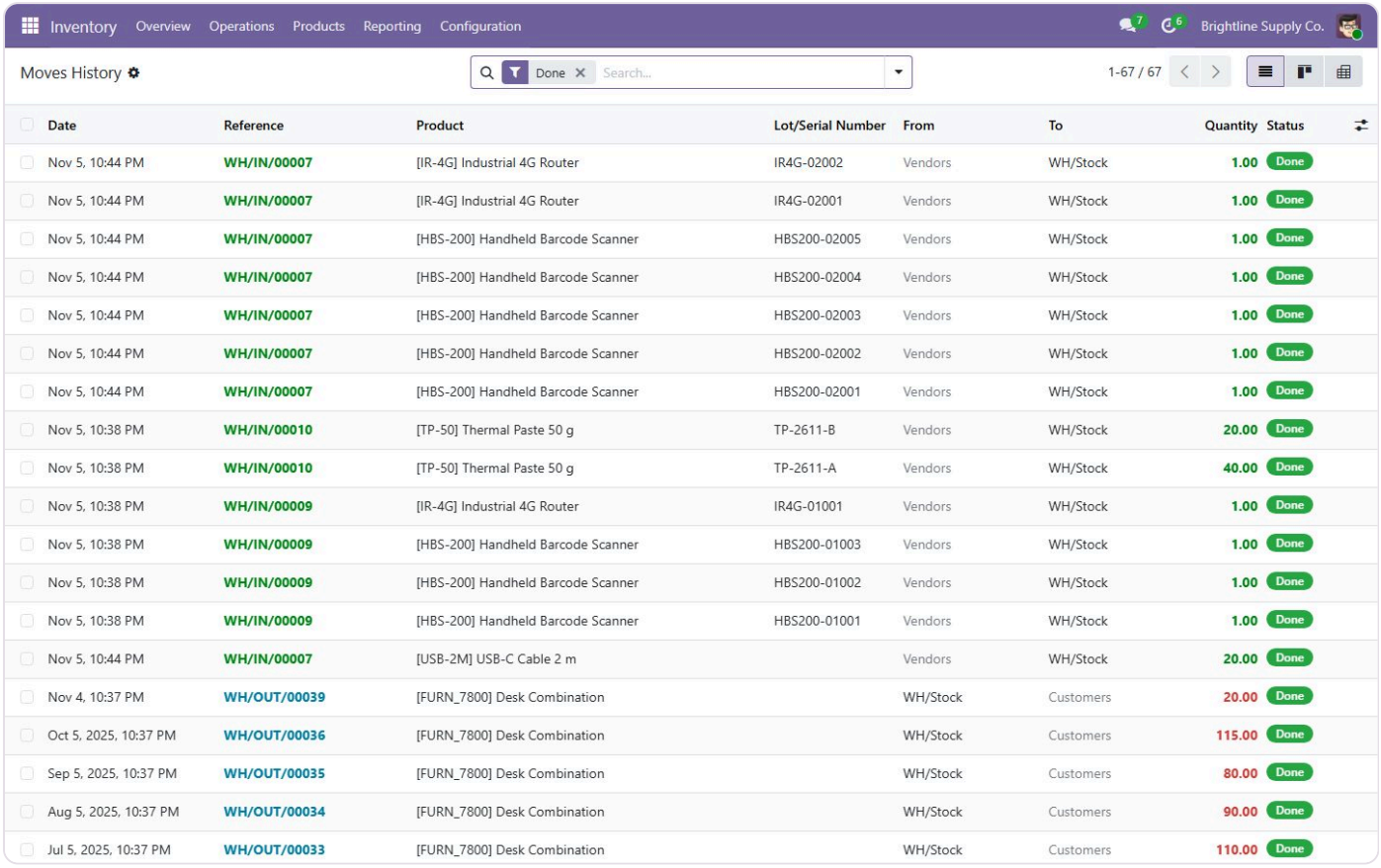
5 The traceability report

Traceability lists every move of the number: the receipt, the date, from the vendor to WH/Stock, and later every delivery, return or transfer. **Print** makes a PDF of it.



6 Moves History

Inventory, Reporting, Moves History lists every move line with its Lot/Serial Number. Filter on a receipt, a product or a number, or group by Lot/Serial Number.



Date	Reference	Product	Lot/Serial Number	From	To	Quantity	Status
Nov 5, 10:44 PM	WH/IN/00007	[IR-4G] Industrial 4G Router	IR4G-02002	Vendors	WH/Stock	1.00	Done
Nov 5, 10:44 PM	WH/IN/00007	[IR-4G] Industrial 4G Router	IR4G-02001	Vendors	WH/Stock	1.00	Done
Nov 5, 10:44 PM	WH/IN/00007	[HBS-200] Handheld Barcode Scanner	HBS200-02005	Vendors	WH/Stock	1.00	Done
Nov 5, 10:44 PM	WH/IN/00007	[HBS-200] Handheld Barcode Scanner	HBS200-02004	Vendors	WH/Stock	1.00	Done
Nov 5, 10:44 PM	WH/IN/00007	[HBS-200] Handheld Barcode Scanner	HBS200-02003	Vendors	WH/Stock	1.00	Done
Nov 5, 10:44 PM	WH/IN/00007	[HBS-200] Handheld Barcode Scanner	HBS200-02002	Vendors	WH/Stock	1.00	Done
Nov 5, 10:44 PM	WH/IN/00007	[HBS-200] Handheld Barcode Scanner	HBS200-02001	Vendors	WH/Stock	1.00	Done
Nov 5, 10:38 PM	WH/IN/00010	[TP-50] Thermal Paste 50 g	TP-2611-B	Vendors	WH/Stock	20.00	Done
Nov 5, 10:38 PM	WH/IN/00010	[TP-50] Thermal Paste 50 g	TP-2611-A	Vendors	WH/Stock	40.00	Done
Nov 5, 10:38 PM	WH/IN/00009	[IR-4G] Industrial 4G Router	IR4G-01001	Vendors	WH/Stock	1.00	Done
Nov 5, 10:38 PM	WH/IN/00009	[HBS-200] Handheld Barcode Scanner	HBS200-01003	Vendors	WH/Stock	1.00	Done
Nov 5, 10:38 PM	WH/IN/00009	[HBS-200] Handheld Barcode Scanner	HBS200-01002	Vendors	WH/Stock	1.00	Done
Nov 5, 10:38 PM	WH/IN/00009	[HBS-200] Handheld Barcode Scanner	HBS200-01001	Vendors	WH/Stock	1.00	Done
Nov 5, 10:44 PM	WH/IN/00007	[USB-2M] USB-C Cable 2 m		Vendors	WH/Stock	20.00	Done
Nov 4, 10:37 PM	WH/OUT/00039	[FURN_7800] Desk Combination		WH/Stock	Customers	20.00	Done
Oct 5, 2025, 10:37 PM	WH/OUT/00036	[FURN_7800] Desk Combination		WH/Stock	Customers	115.00	Done
Sep 5, 2025, 10:37 PM	WH/OUT/00035	[FURN_7800] Desk Combination		WH/Stock	Customers	80.00	Done
Aug 5, 2025, 10:37 PM	WH/OUT/00034	[FURN_7800] Desk Combination		WH/Stock	Customers	90.00	Done
Jul 5, 2025, 10:37 PM	WH/OUT/00033	[FURN_7800] Desk Combination		WH/Stock	Customers	110.00	Done

Print serial labels

Select serials in the Lots / Serial Numbers list and choose **Print, Lot/Serial Number** to print a label per number with its barcode. Stick them on the units at the receiving desk so the warehouse can scan them later.



Three serial labels from the standard Lot/Serial Number report: product, reference and a Code 128 barcode of the serial.

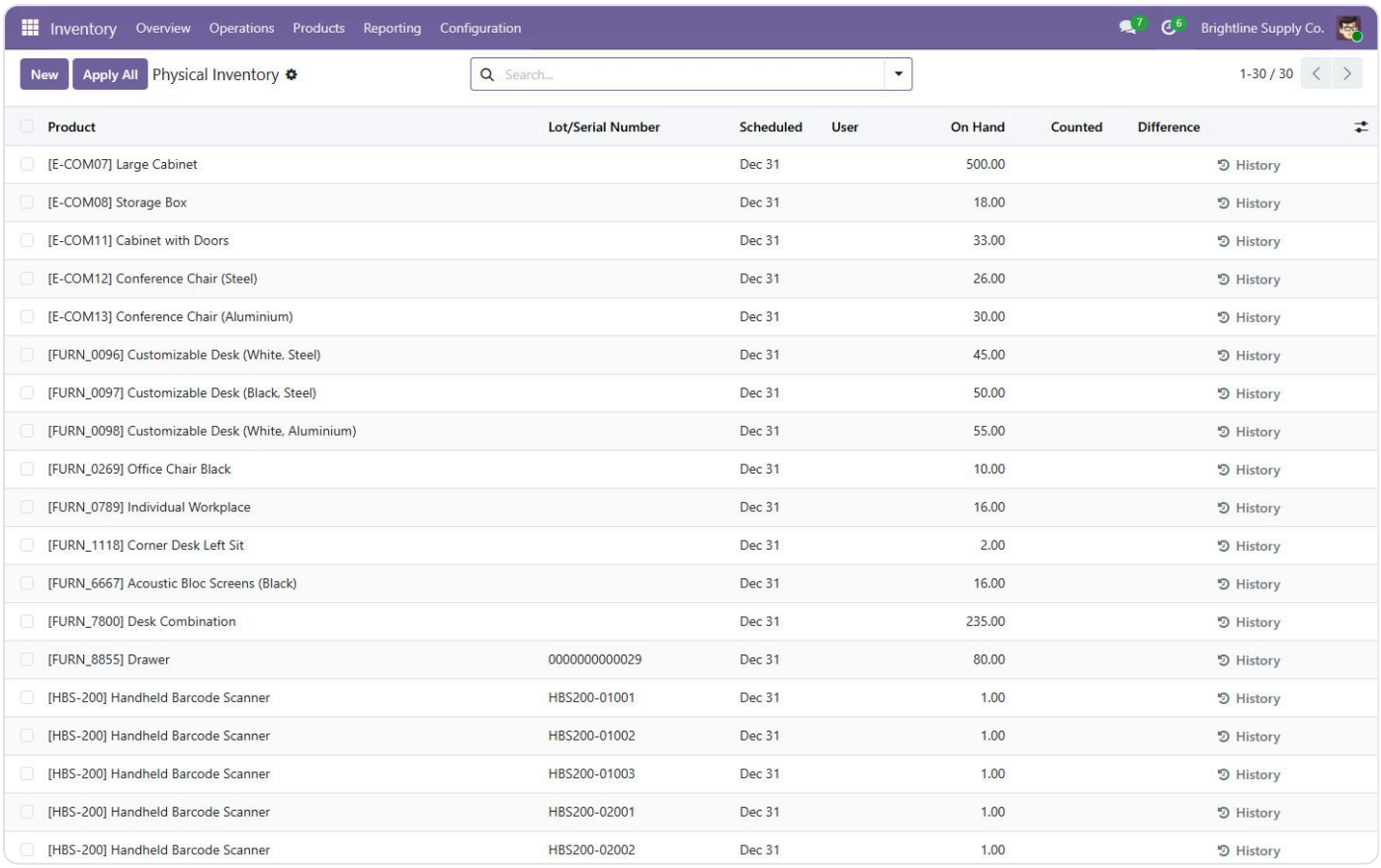
PART 9 Stock you already hold, and returns

Two situations finish the picture: units already on the shelf before tracking was turned on, and sending a unit back to the vendor.

1 Give serials to stock already on hand

Go to **Inventory, Operations, Physical Inventory**. The list now has a **Lot/Serial Number** column. For a product switched to serial tracking, enter one line per unit with its serial and a counted quantity of 1, and set the line without a number to zero. Press **Apply**.

> Count the shelf first. The adjustment both names the units and corrects the quantity.



Product	Lot/Serial Number	Scheduled	User	On Hand	Counted	Difference	
[E-COM07] Large Cabinet		Dec 31		500.00			History
[E-COM08] Storage Box		Dec 31		18.00			History
[E-COM11] Cabinet with Doors		Dec 31		33.00			History
[E-COM12] Conference Chair (Steel)		Dec 31		26.00			History
[E-COM13] Conference Chair (Aluminium)		Dec 31		30.00			History
[FURN_0096] Customizable Desk (White, Steel)		Dec 31		45.00			History
[FURN_0097] Customizable Desk (Black, Steel)		Dec 31		50.00			History
[FURN_0098] Customizable Desk (White, Aluminium)		Dec 31		55.00			History
[FURN_0269] Office Chair Black		Dec 31		10.00			History
[FURN_0789] Individual Workplace		Dec 31		16.00			History
[FURN_1118] Corner Desk Left Sit		Dec 31		2.00			History
[FURN_6667] Acoustic Bloc Screens (Black)		Dec 31		16.00			History
[FURN_7800] Desk Combination		Dec 31		235.00			History
[FURN_8855] Drawer	0000000000029	Dec 31		80.00			History
[HBS-200] Handheld Barcode Scanner	HBS200-01001	Dec 31		1.00			History
[HBS-200] Handheld Barcode Scanner	HBS200-01002	Dec 31		1.00			History
[HBS-200] Handheld Barcode Scanner	HBS200-01003	Dec 31		1.00			History
[HBS-200] Handheld Barcode Scanner	HBS200-02001	Dec 31		1.00			History
[HBS-200] Handheld Barcode Scanner	HBS200-02002	Dec 31		1.00			History

2 Return units to the vendor

On the done receipt press **Return**. Enter the quantity per product and confirm with **Return**. On the return transfer, open Details and pick the serials going back; with Use Existing ones on its operation type, only numbers in stock are offered.

> The serial's traceability then shows the receipt and the return, so the history stays complete.



PART 10 Questions, a checklist and the menu map

QUESTION	ANSWER
Can I type serials on the purchase order line?	Not in standard Odoo 19. The order line has no serial field; serials go on the receipt. Entering them on the order needs a small custom module that writes them onto the receipt when the order is confirmed
Do I need Odoo Enterprise?	No. Lots and serials, Generate, Import, the Lots / Serial Numbers list and the traceability report are all in Community. The Barcode app is Enterprise, but a USB scanner types serials into the Details lines in Community
Can a vendor send a spreadsheet of serials?	Yes. Copy the column and paste it into Import Serials/Lots
What if one unit arrives damaged?	Receive it and return it (part 9), or leave it off the receipt and keep the rest on a backorder
Can I find a serial from a customer complaint?	Search it under Lots / Serial Numbers; Purchase and Traceability show the vendor, the date and every move since
Can I print the serials on delivery slips?	Yes, with Display Lots & Serial Numbers on Delivery Slips in the settings

Go-live checklist

STEP	DONE
Lots & Serial Numbers on, and Expiration Dates if you need them	
Each tracked product set to By Unique Serial Number or By Lots	
Receipts operation type: Create New on, in every warehouse	
Stock already on the shelf given its numbers with a physical inventory	
A USB scanner at the receiving desk, tested in a Details line	
One test receipt received and traced end to end	

Where everything is

Inventory, Configuration

Settings, Traceability	Lots & Serial Numbers, Expiration Dates, lots on delivery slips
Operation Types, Receipts	Create New and Use Existing ones for lots and serials

Inventory, Products

Products, General Information	Track Inventory: By Unique Serial Number or By Lots
Products, Inventory tab	Expiration dates per product, with Expiration Dates on
Lots / Serial Numbers	Every serial and lot, with Purchase and Traceability buttons

Purchase

Orders, Purchase	The order; Receive opens its receipt

Inventory, Operations

Receipts	Details on each line: Generate or Import serials, then Validate
Physical Inventory	Give serials to stock that is already on the shelf

Inventory, Reporting

Moves History	Every move with its lot or serial number

Want serial tracking set up for you?

We switch tracking on without disturbing the stock you already hold, give your shelf stock its serials, set up labels and scanners for the receiving desk, and train the team, so every unit can be traced from the vendor to the customer.

way4tech.com · info@way4tech.com